# PROSPER AWUNI

**Senior Security Engineer | SOC Platform Engineering | SIEM | EDR | SOAR | Detection Engineering**

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of progressive experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) engineering, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) deployment and optimisation, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) management, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) development. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I build and maintain core SOC platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM and EDR, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an enterprise of over 8,000 users. I write detection content, automation playbooks, and threat-hunting logic using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and PowerShell, and I systematically apply MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to design and validate detections against realistic adversary behaviour. I have strong experience with vulnerability management tooling including Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and I operate across governance frameworks including NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus. I am seeking a senior engineering role where I can design, deploy, and continually improve the technical controls that underpin a high-performing SOC.

## CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM, Splunk / Security Information and Event Management (familiarity)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Automation and Logic Apps, PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook design; Cortex XSOAR (awareness); Splunk SOAR (awareness)
- **Detection Engineering:** Kusto Query Language (KQL), custom detection rule authoring, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, threat-hunting playbook development
- **Threat Intelligence and Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, structured threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) management
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, Microsoft Sentinel
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera BAS, AppCheck, risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell (advanced), Bash, Python (working knowledge)
- **Endpoint Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**University of the Arts London (UAL)** *March 2025 - Present*

**Senior Cyber Security Engineer**

- Design, deploy, and maintain core SOC platform technologies including CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM, EDR and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM across an enterprise estate of over 8,000 users, ensuring continuous visibility across endpoint, identity, and cloud attack surfaces.
- Write and maintain detection content in KQL within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, mapping detections to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to ensure coverage of adversary behaviour patterns relevant to higher education sector threats.

- Design and develop SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Automation and Logic Apps, automating alert triage and initial response workflows to reduce analyst workload and improve mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries, investigating anomalous behaviour, lateral movement, and credential-based attack patterns within the enterprise environment.
- Manage and optimise EDR policies across CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, tuning detection thresholds, exclusions, and prevention policies to balance security efficacy with operational stability.
- Oversee the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera BAS, and AppCheck, applying risk-based prioritisation aligned to CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) for Active Directory threat detection, identifying and responding to credential theft, pass-the-hash, Kerberoasting, and other identity-based attacks.
- Develop and maintain PowerShell-based automation scripts for security operations tasks including log parsing, bulk account management, and automated incident enrichment.
- Maintain Check Point Harmony firewall rule sets, enforcing network segmentation and least-privilege access principles across campus and cloud environments.
- Govern BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), managing secure access to privileged accounts and enforcing session recording and least-privilege controls for administrative staff.
- Produce post-incident reports with root-cause analysis and lessons-learned documentation aligned to the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle.

**University of the Arts London (UAL)** *March 2022 - March 2025*

**Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**

- Performed SIEM alert triage and investigation across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, managing Tier 1 to Tier 2 security event escalation and response within defined Service Level Agreements (SLAs).
- Authored KQL detection queries and threat-hunting rules within Microsoft Sentinel, systematically applying MITRE ATT&CK to prioritise detection coverage for high-risk attack techniques.
- Supported the SOC platform build-out, contributing to the deployment and integration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and CrowdStrike Falcon into the Sentinel SIEM environment.
- Managed Azure AD / Entra ID user lifecycle and Conditional Access policies, enforcing MFA and governance controls across staff and student populations.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, reporting findings and tracking remediation with IT infrastructure teams using a risk-based prioritisation approach.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM onboarding, managing the migration of privileged accounts to the centralised PAM platform and enforcing least-privilege access policies.
- Developed and delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns using automated tooling, improving phishing reporting rates across the institution.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus audit preparation, compiling technical evidence and supporting audit teams during certification renewals.

**HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)** *February 2021 - March 2022*

**IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure**

- Managed security operations for a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, maintaining endpoint security controls, patch management workflows, and network access policies.
- Implemented identity and access management controls including role-based access control (RBAC) and MFA enforcement across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Monitored security alerts from endpoint and network security tools, investigating anomalies and escalating confirmed security incidents to senior engineers.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server maintenance, network configuration, and endpoint provisioning, contributing to the security hardening of a growing cloud-first organisation.

## KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised a SOAR automation capability in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage for over 60% of common incident types and reducing analyst response times by an average of 70% for high-severity events.
- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Next-Generation SIEM across an enterprise of over 8,000 endpoints, achieving full detection coverage and establishing structured detection engineering lifecycle processes.

- Authored over 30 custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, improving threat detection coverage for credential-based attacks, lateral movement, and exfiltration patterns.
- Reduced false-positive EDR alert volume by over 40% through systematic tuning of CrowdStrike Falcon prevention policies, exclusion sets, and detection thresholds.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate detection and prevention coverage, driving measurable improvements in mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Contributed to successful ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification and renewal, providing technical evidence and supporting auditor queries across the security engineering domain.

## EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (UK)